AWS Day 2 Operations & Troubleshooting

NorthBank

Module: Pre-Flight Briefing & Sandbox Setup

Essential prerequisites to run the course safely, cleanly, and cost-effectively. Tools, budget alarms, and sandbox deployment rules—do this once before you start.



REV 2.0 | TECHNICAL DOCUMENT | AWS OPS | NORTHBANK ENG

NotebookLM

~/prerequisites/01-system-requirements



Personal / Sandbox AWS Account

Strict rule—never shared, never a production environment.



Active Card on File

AWS Free Tier will not fully cover the footpint of this course.



Baseline Competency

Basic command-line comfort is the primary technical bar for entry.



Local Environment

Must have `AWS CLI v2`, `Terraform`, and `jq` installed and configured.

NotebookLM

~/prerequisites/02-financial-guardrails



Financial Limit Monitor

Action Required — Do this before creating anything else.

$20 / month AWS Budget Alarm

`AlertThreshold = 80%`

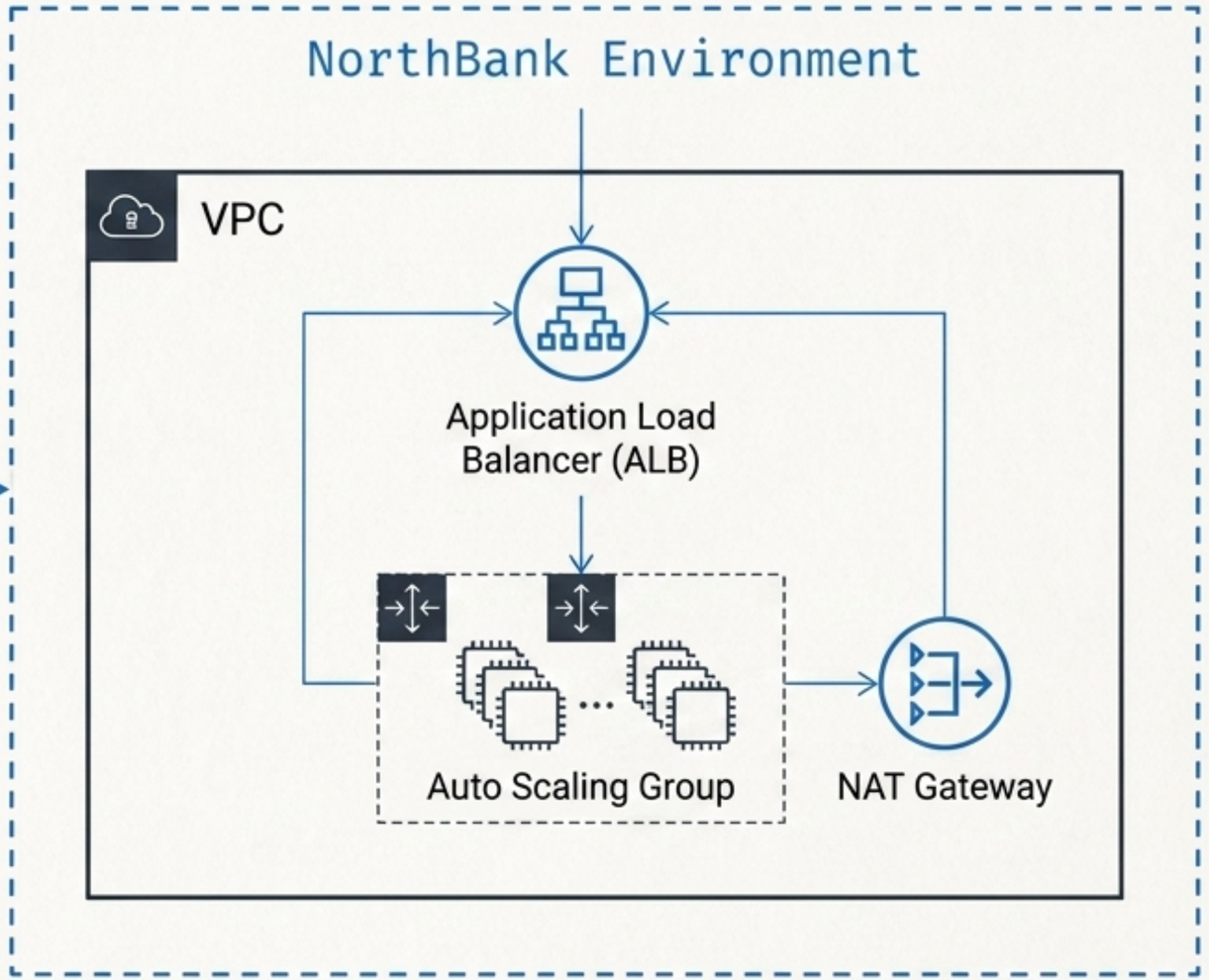
This is your automated safety net. If lab infrastructure is accidentally left running overnight, this ensures you are notified before incurring significant personal costs.

NotebookLM

~/prerequisites/03-sandbox-architecture

```
terraform init
terraform apply
```

Provisions the complete environment in 3–5 minutes.



Every lab features a `break.sh` script designed to target and manipulate this exact, isolated environment.

NotebookLM

~/prerequisites/04-sandbox-economics

~$2.15 / day

Covers the full base stack (VPC, ALB, ASG, NAT Gateway).

+

+$0.40 / day

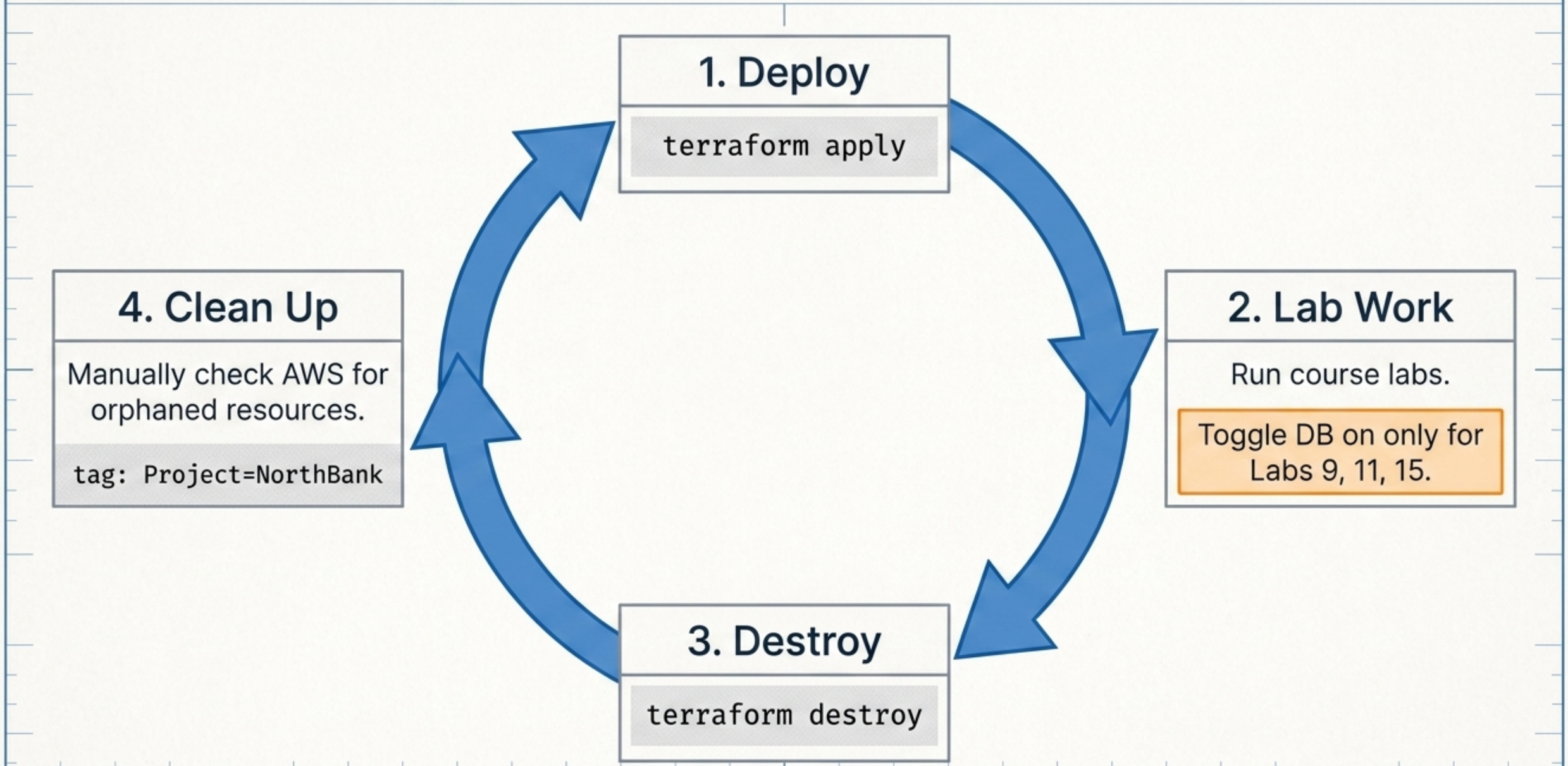
Database is OFF by default. Only required for Labs 9, 11, and 15.

Projected Total: $5 – $15 for the entire course.

This projection strictly assumes complete teardown after each daily session.

NotebookLM

~/prerequisites/05-daily-ops-loop



NotebookLM

~/prerequisites/06-launch-status

[✓]

Guardrails Active

The $20 Budget alarm is configured and active in the AWS console.

[✓]

Environment Verified

The output `app_url` successfully loads the NorthBank web page in a local browser.

[✓]

Ops Memorized

You know `terraform destroy` and the `Project=NorthBank` leftover-finder tag by heart.

```
> If all systems green,
  proceed to Lab 1
```

NotebookLM